

ON-SET REFERENCE • KEEP OPEN WHILE FILMING

Shooting Checklist

Pre-shoot setup, hook ideas, transitions, cuts & b-roll — everything you need on your phone during a shoot.

Companion to your 30-Day Plan • @mahe_r.eddits

1 Before you press record

Run through this once at the start of every shooting session.

Phone settings

- ☐ Camera set to **4K, 60fps** (slow-mo looks premium)
- ☐ Orientation **locked vertical 9:16**
- ☐ **DND / airplane mode ON** — no calls mid-take
- ☐ Wipe the **lens** with a cloth (greasy lens = soft footage)
- ☐ At least **5 GB free** storage + battery above 50%
- ☐ Grid lines ON for framing

Lighting

- ☐ **Face the window** — never shoot with the window behind you
- ☐ Best light: **sunrise or golden hour** (soft, flattering)
- ☐ Keep light **consistent** across all clips in one reel
- ☐ No harsh overhead light on your face (raccoon shadows)

Framing

- ☐ Leave **headroom** — don't cut off the top of your head
- ☐ Keep subject roughly **centred** for vertical
- ☐ **Safe zones:** keep text/action ~108px from top, ~320px from bottom
- ☐ Phone on a **tripod / gimbal** for anything not handheld-intentional
- ☐ Lock **focus + exposure** (tap & hold on your face) so it doesn't drift

Audio

- ☐ Record in the **quietest room** you can; close windows
- ☐ Record **voiceover separately** (phone close to mouth) — cleaner than on-cam
- ☐ Avoid wind / fans / AC hum in the background
- ☐ Clap once at the start of a take to sync audio later if needed

Continuity

- ☐ Same **outfit + setup** for every clip inside one reel
- ☐ Note where you stood / how you framed, so cuts match
- ☐ Shoot a few **seconds extra** before & after each action (room to trim)

2 Hook bank — first 1–2 seconds

The first second decides everything. Open with one of these — never with an intro.

★ Signature egg	Drink the raw egg, hold the weird intense face 1 sec, hard cut into the reel. Use on cornerstone days only (1, 8, 15, 22, 30).
Crash zoom face	Start wide, snap-zoom fast onto your face on the first beat. Instant attention.
Mid-action open	Begin already moving — barbell racking, knife chopping, shoe lacing. No slow intros.
Text-on-black	1 sec black screen with a bold line (“POV: you finally woke up early”) → reveal.
Point & warn	Look dead at camera, point: “Don’t do what I did.” → cut to the story.
Object drop	Drop items onto a desk/floor one-by-one on the beat, then “Let’s break it down.”
Walk-to-camera	Walk straight toward the lens; cut the instant you fill the frame.
Before/after tease	Flash Day 1 vs today for half a second, then “Here’s how.”
Question hook	Ask the exact question your viewer is thinking: “How do I train with a 9-hour job?”

Rotate your hooks. Save the ★ egg for cornerstone days (1, 8, 15, 22, 30) so it stays special. Use a fresh hook on the others — identical openings every day can flatten reach.

3 Transitions library

Film the IN and OUT of each clip with the transition in mind. Green = easy, orange = needs a little practice.

Jump cut Easy

Same frame, chop out the dead time / pauses. Your default — use it everywhere to keep pace.

Hand / object swipe Easy

Cover the lens with your hand or an object → cut → uncover on a new scene. Looks seamless.

Whip pan Medium

Swing the phone fast L → R at the end of clip A; start clip B with the same fast swing. Editor blurs the seam.

Match cut Medium

Match a shape or motion across two clips — reach for a door, cut to reaching for a dumbbell. Very satisfying.

Snap / clap change Easy

Snap fingers or clap; on the sound, instantly change outfit / location. Great for 'getting ready'.

Speed ramp Medium

Slow-mo into a moment, then snap to normal speed on impact (bar hits the rack, foot hits the floor).

Crash zoom Easy

Quick punch-in zoom on a beat for emphasis (add in CapCut if you didn't zoom on camera).

Mask / walk-behind Medium

Walk behind a pillar/wall; cut while the frame is fully blocked → reveal new scene. Looks pro.

Object wipe Easy

Let something pass right across the lens (a bag, your arm); cut underneath it.

Light off → on Easy

Turn the room dark / close a door to black, cut, then reveal the next setting lit.

L-cut / J-cut Medium

Let the audio of the next clip start before its video (or vice-versa). Makes talking clips flow.

Turn-around (180°) Medium

Spin past camera; cut on the spin so you reappear somewhere new.

4 Cuts & pacing rules

- **First frame is the hook** — no logos, no “hey guys”. Action or text immediately.
- **Cut every 1.5–3 seconds**. If a shot doesn't add energy or info, delete it.
- **Cut on motion** (a hand reaching, a step, an impact) — it hides the seam.
- **Cut on the beat** of your audio so the edit feels musical.
- **Kill all dead air** — pauses, ‘um’s, walking-into-frame. Ruthless.
- **Match the action** across a cut so movement continues smoothly.
- Layer **b-roll over your voiceover** instead of staring at the camera the whole time.

5 Always-grab b-roll

Capture a few of these every shoot — they're what you lay over voiceovers.

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Alarm / phone screen close-up | ☐ Commute time-lapse (metro / bike / road) |
| ☐ Feet hitting the floor / shoes lacing | ☐ Desk setup, laptop opening, standup over-shoulder |
| ☐ Water pouring / your signature bottle | ☐ Hands on keyboard / coffee being poured |
| ☐ Sweat, chalk, plates loading (gym texture) | ☐ Wide 'hero' silhouette shot at sunrise |
| ☐ Food being chopped / plated / packed | ☐ Mirror / progress check shot |

6 Before you move to the next clip

- ☐ Hook lands in the **first 1 second**
- ☐ Action is **centred** and in the safe zone
- ☐ Focus + exposure **locked** (not drifting)
- ☐ Got **2–3 takes** of the key action
- ☐ Grabbed **extra b-roll** for this scene
- ☐ Outfit / lighting **matches** the rest of the reel

7 Editing checklist (CapCut / InShot)

Run this before you export and post each reel.

- ☐ Hook is the very first frame — trim anything before it
- ☐ Pace: a cut every 1.5–3 sec, dead air removed
- ☐ Captions added, **in the safe zone**, bold high-contrast font (Poppins/Montserrat)
- ☐ Audio = **your voiceover** or **Instagram in-app Sound Collection** only
- ☐ **No ripped songs, no other creators' audio**, no watermarked clips
- ☐ Pick a strong **cover frame** (the thumbnail people see in your grid)
- ☐ End with your **CTA** (follow / comment / save)
- ☐ Export **1080×1920, highest quality**, then post from a **Creator account**

Account-safety reminder: original voiceover or Instagram's in-app Sound Collection only. Never rip trending songs or reuse other creators' / watermarked clips — Instagram detects audio even at low volume and quietly tanks your reach. Post from a Creator account; skip bots and follow/unfollow tools entirely.

Built for @mahe_r.eddits • Record more than you think you need — you can't edit footage you didn't shoot.